life itself. Moreover, the emptiness experienced by easing one's obsessive hold on a fixed self or things is declared by Nagarjuna to be the Buddha's middle way.'

11 B. Subrahmanyam et al, *Buddhist Circuits of Andhra Pradesh*, 2011; Peter Skilling, 'New discoveries from South India: the life of the Buddha at Phanigiri', *Arts Asiatiques*, Vol. 63 (1), 2008.

12 See M. Arunchalam, *The Kalabhras in the Pandyan country*, 1979.

13 Tanlin, *Treatise on the Two Entrances and Four Practices*, c. 575. Quoted in Hutan Ashrafian, *Warrior Origins: the historical and legendary links between Bodhidharma, Saholin Kung-Fu, Karate and Ninjutsu*, 2014. See also Father Heinrich Dumoulin's classic *Zen Buddhism: a History*, revised ed., 2005.

14 Bodhidarma's links with kung fu begin with a manual supposedly written by him entitled *Yijin Jing* or 'Muscle Training Classic'. Research by Chinese scholars in the 1960s concluded that this was the work of a Taoist priest named Zining written in 1624. Bodhidharma the martial arts master only entered the public domain with the publication of a picaresque novel called *The Travels of Lao T'san*, published in 1907 by a Chinese author named Liu T'ieh-yun. This was very quickly picked up and adopted as fact by various martial arts practitioners in China, not least those at Shaolin. See M. Shahar, *The Shaolin Monastery: History, Religion, and the Chinese Martial Arts*, 2008.

15 The British Museum has a most elegant bronze standing statue of Tara from the eighth century, who may have come from the mainland. She was found lying by the roadside between Trincomalee and Batticaloa in the 1890s, having been dumped there by a local monastery in a clear-out of all Mahayana elements at a time when Theravada Buddhism in Ceylon was undergoing a major